

KS3: Causes of the Great War

High-Yield Revision Cheat Sheet

1. Master Glossary

Term	Definition
Alsace-Lorraine	A resource-rich border region taken by Germany from France in 1871.
Arms Race	A competition between nations to achieve superiority in the quantity and quality of military weapons.
Assassination	The murder of a prominent person, often a political leader or ruler.
Black Hand	A secret Serbian society that used terrorist methods to promote the liberation of Serbs outside Serbia.
Colony	A country or area under the full or partial political control of another country.
Dreadnought	A revolutionary type of heavily-armoured battleship introduced by Britain in 1906.
Empire	An extensive group of states or countries ruled over by a single supreme authority.
Ems Telegram	A diplomatic message altered by Bismarck to provoke France into declaring war.
Encirclement	A military term for the situation when a force or target is isolated and surrounded by enemy forces.
Imperialism	A policy of extending a country's power and influence through diplomacy or military force.
Mobilisation	The action of a country or its government preparing and organizing troops for active service.
Naval Supremacy	Having the most powerful and dominant navy in the world.
Reinsurance Treaty	A secret agreement between Germany and Russia arranged by Bismarck to prevent a two-front war.
Reparations	Massive financial fines forced upon a defeated nation to pay for war damages.
Scramble for Africa	The rapid invasion, annexation, and division of African territory by European powers.
Siege	A military operation where enemy forces surround a town or building, cutting off essential supplies.
Triple Alliance	A secret agreement between Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Italy formed in May 1882.

Term	Definition
Triple Entente	The military alliance linking the Russian Empire, the French Third Republic, and the United Kingdom.
Two-Power Standard	A British policy stating their navy must be as large as the next two largest navies combined.
Ultimatum	A final demand or statement of terms, the rejection of which will result in retaliation or a breakdown in relations.

2. Key Individuals Matrix

Kaiser Wilhelm II

Emperor of Germany

The impulsive and militaristic ruler of Germany whose aggressive 'Weltpolitik' foreign policy alienated Britain, France, and Russia, setting the stage for the Great War.

Gavrilo Princip

Serbian Nationalist

A member of the Black Hand secret society who assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand in Sarajevo, providing the spark that ignited the July Crisis and World War I.

Tsar Nicholas II

Emperor of Russia

The autocratic ruler of Russia who mobilized his vast army to defend Serbia against Austria-Hungary, triggering Germany's mobilization and the activation of the Schlieffen Plan.

3. Exam Question Bank

- [How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the reasons for French hatred of Germany after 1871? (8 marks)
- [To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the impact of Weltpolitik on international relations? (8 marks)
- [Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the effects of the Anglo-German naval arms race? (8 marks)
- [Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the threat posed by Serbia to Austria-Hungary? (8 marks)
- [Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the causes of the outbreak of World War I? (8 marks)